

VIDEO CREATOR MONETIZATION GUIDE

Platforms to sell your content · YouTube · TikTok · Instagram

Every platform explained, with step-by-step activation guides and AI automation tips for each.

Researched April 2026 | Sources: official platform docs + creator community data

How to use this guide

This guide covers two things: (1) the best platforms to sell video content, courses, and memberships — similar to Whop — and (2) a step-by-step walkthrough for enabling monetization on YouTube, TikTok, and Instagram, with specific AI strategies for each.

The two money models for video creators

Every video creator has two paths to earn: native platform monetization (getting paid by the platform you post on) and owned monetization (selling directly to your audience through a separate platform you control). The smartest creators use both — native platforms build the audience, owned platforms capture the real money.

Native monetization	Owned monetization
YouTube ad share, TikTok Creator Rewards, Instagram badges. Platform pays you based on views. Low per-view rates. Platform owns the rules and can change them.	Whop, Kajabi, Teachable etc. You sell courses, memberships, and digital products directly. Higher margins. You own the customer relationship. No algorithm dependency.

SECTION 1 — PLATFORMS TO SELL VIDEO CONTENT & COURSES

Video content & course selling platforms

These platforms let you sell courses, memberships, digital downloads, and community access directly to your audience — without relying on a social platform's algorithm or ad revenue. This is owned monetization: you set the price, keep most of the money, and own the customer relationship.

Whop

AI: HIGH

The all-in-one marketplace for digital products, courses, and memberships. Low 2.7% fee, no monthly cost.

What it is

Whop is a digital marketplace where creators can sell virtually any digital product: video courses, paid communities, software, subscriptions, masterminds, or digital downloads. It functions like a Discord-style hub where members interact with you and your content in one place. Over \$2 billion in products have been sold on Whop.

Fees

Platform fee	2.7% + \$0.30 per transaction — no monthly subscription
Monthly cost	\$0 — Whop only earns when you earn
Payout	Via Stripe, within standard payout cycles
Best for	All-in-one: courses + community + digital products + livestreaming

Key features

- Sell courses, memberships, subscriptions, software licenses, and digital downloads from one dashboard
- Built-in livestreaming — no need for a separate platform
- Discord-style community interface with channels, posts, and leaderboards
- Affiliate program built-in: let others promote your product for a commission
- Built-in analytics, checkout, and buy now pay later payment options
- Public Discover page for organic discoverability

How to use AI to automate and scale on Whop

- Use Claude or ChatGPT to write your entire course curriculum — outline modules, lesson titles, and descriptions before recording a single video.

- AI can generate your sales page copy: headline, bullet points, pricing justification, FAQ, and testimonial prompts to send early students.
- Use AI to create a week-by-week content drip schedule so students always have something new to look forward to — reduces churn.
- Generate your Whop community welcome message, pinned posts, and weekly engagement prompts with AI to keep members active.
- Use AI to write affiliate recruitment emails — pitch other creators in your niche to promote your Whop for a commission.
- AI can help you produce a 'lead magnet' freebie (PDF guide, mini course, checklist) to drive traffic to your paid Whop.
- Use Claude to draft onboarding sequences: the first 3 emails a new member receives, timed for days 1, 3, and 7.

Kajabi

AI: HIGH

All-in-one platform for courses, memberships, email marketing, and coaching. Premium but powerful.

What it is

Kajabi is the most feature-complete creator platform available. It handles courses, memberships, podcasts, newsletters, coaching programs, landing pages, email marketing, and sales funnels — all in one place. No transaction fees, but the monthly subscription is high.

Fees

Transaction fee	0% — none
Monthly cost	\$55–\$319/month (billed annually), 14-day free trial
Best for	Established creators wanting everything under one roof without duct-taping tools together
Weakness	Expensive. Complex for beginners. Overkill if you only sell one product.

Key features

- Full course builder with video hosting, quizzes, and completion certificates
- Built-in email marketing with automation and broadcast emails
- Membership sites with community features and live rooms
- Sales funnel builder and landing page editor
- Coaching tools with calendar and session management
- Podcast and newsletter hosting built-in

How to use AI on Kajabi

- Use AI to generate full email marketing sequences — welcome series, nurture campaigns, and cart abandonment flows.
- AI can write your course sales page from scratch: hook, problem statement, solution, curriculum outline, and objection-handling FAQ.
- Use Claude to plan and script every video lesson in your course before you record — reduces retakes and editing time.
- AI can draft weekly newsletter content for your Kajabi membership to keep subscribers engaged and reduce churn.
- Use AI to write compelling landing page copy for each product in your Kajabi store.

Teachable

AI: HIGH

The simplest and most beginner-friendly platform for selling video courses. Clean, minimal, no code.

What it is

Teachable is the go-to platform for creators launching their first paid course. Its drag-and-drop builder is the most intuitive in the market. It supports video, audio, text, and quizzes, plus one-time purchases, subscriptions, and coaching offers. Less powerful than Kajabi but much simpler to start.

Fees

Transaction fee	5% on Basic (\$36/mo); 0% on Start (\$74/mo) and above
Monthly cost	\$36–\$374/month (billed annually)
Best for	First-time course creators who want to launch fast without technical complexity
Weakness	Less community and marketing depth than Kajabi; fees on basic tier

Key features

- Drag-and-drop course builder with multimedia support
- Coaching and live session scheduling built-in
- Basic community discussion boards per course
- Student progress tracking and completion certificates
- Built-in checkout and affiliate management

How to use AI on Teachable

- Use AI to outline your course: generate module titles, lesson structure, and learning objectives in minutes.
- AI can write all your lesson scripts so you read from a teleprompter app — no need to memorize anything.
- Use Claude to generate quiz questions and answer choices from your lesson content automatically.
- AI can write student success stories and social proof framing to increase course conversions.

Thinkific

AI: HIGH

Course platform with strong community tools, drip content, and branded mobile apps.

What it is

Thinkific is a strong mid-tier course platform positioned between Teachable (simple) and Kajabi (complex). Its strength is community building alongside courses — members can interact, share content, and post in feeds. It also supports branded mobile apps, making your course feel like a premium product.

Fees

Transaction fee	0% on all paid plans
Monthly cost	\$36–\$374/month (billed annually), free tier available (1 course)
Best for	Creators who want course + community without Kajabi's complexity or price
Weakness	Email marketing requires integration (no built-in); branded app costs extra

Key features

- Drip content scheduling — release lessons over time to keep members engaged
- Community spaces with activity feeds, posts, and member interaction
- Branded mobile app (add-on) for iOS and Android
- Live cohort hosting with event scheduling
- Flexible pricing: one-time, subscription, and payment plans

How to use AI on Thinkific

- Use AI to plan a drip content calendar — decide which lessons unlock on which days to optimise completion rates.
- AI can generate community engagement prompts: weekly discussion questions, challenges, and polls.
- Use Claude to write welcome sequences for new students and win-back emails for inactive members.

Gumroad

AI: HIGH

Zero-barrier marketplace for digital downloads, courses, and subscriptions. Start for free.

What it is

Gumroad is the simplest way to start selling anything digital. Upload a file, set a price, share the link — that is it. It supports courses, ebooks, audio, templates, presets, and subscriptions. No monthly fee on the free plan (10% transaction fee). An excellent starting point before moving to a dedicated platform.

Fees

Free plan	10% transaction fee per sale
Premium (\$10/mo)	Reduces transaction fee to ~3% depending on volume
Best for	First product launches, digital downloads, small creators testing demand
Weakness	Limited community and marketing tools vs Whop/Kajabi

How to use AI on Gumroad

- Use AI to write your product description, headline, and bullet points — Gumroad product pages are pure copywriting.
- AI can generate a 5-email launch sequence to send to your existing audience when you publish a new product.
- Use Claude to create the product itself: AI can draft ebook content, course scripts, or template descriptions.
- AI can identify the best price point for your niche by researching comparable products — ask Claude to analyse Gumroad bestsellers in your category.

Skool

AI: MODERATE

Community + courses in one platform. Gamification drives engagement. Popular with info-product creators.

What it is

Skool combines a course builder with a community forum in a gamified environment. Members earn points and level up by engaging. It is popular among course creators who want a tight-knit community around their content. Flat pricing with no transaction fees. Discoverability via Skool's homepage.

Fees

Monthly cost	\$99/month flat — no transaction fees
Transaction fee	0%
Best for	Engaged niche communities, info-product creators, creators who want to incentivise member activity
Weakness	Less flexible than Whop; no digital download sales; no livestreaming; Zoom required for live events

How to use AI on Skool

- Use AI to write your Skool community welcome post, rules, pinned resources, and first 30 days of discussion prompts.
- AI can draft a gamification strategy: what behaviours earn the most points, and how to structure levels and rewards.
- Use Claude to write weekly engagement posts that drive comments and keep your leaderboard active.

Mighty Networks

AI: MODERATE

Community-first platform with courses and live events. Best for building tribes around a shared interest.

What it is

Mighty Networks prioritises community over content. It is designed for creators who want to build a 'network' — a group of people who connect with each other, not just with you. Courses and events sit inside the community. Strong integrations with Zoom, ConvertKit, and Zapier.

Fees

Monthly cost	\$99–\$179/month (billed annually)
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Transaction fee	2–3% depending on plan
Best for	Creators with an existing audience who want a branded social network around a niche
Weakness	Higher learning curve; community setup requires real effort to launch well

How to use AI on Mighty Networks

- Use AI to write the community manifesto, member handbook, and onboarding flow for new members.
- AI can generate course content, quizzes, and discussion prompts across all your Networks spaces.
- Use Claude to build a Zapier automation strategy: identify which actions (new member joined, course completed) should trigger emails or posts.

Podia

AI: HIGH

Affordable all-in-one for courses, downloads, webinars, and email. Best value under \$50/month.

What it is

Podia combines a digital storefront, course builder, email marketing, and webinar hosting in one clean interface. It is the most affordable full-featured alternative to Kajabi, with a free plan and paid plans starting low. Ideal for creators who want a professional setup without the Kajabi price tag.

Fees

Free plan	8% transaction fee
Mover (\$39/mo)	5% transaction fee — unlimited products, email marketing
Shaker (\$89/mo)	0% transaction fee — affiliate programme, blog
Best for	Budget-conscious creators who want course + email + webinars without separate tools

How to use AI on Podia

- Use AI to write your full email marketing funnel: lead magnet opt-in, nurture sequence, and course pitch emails.
- AI can create webinar scripts, slide outlines, and follow-up emails for your Podia webinars.

- Use Claude to generate affiliate recruitment copy for your Podia affiliate programme.

Payhip

AI: HIGH

Simplest low-cost option for digital downloads, courses, and memberships. Free to start.

What it is

Payhip is the easiest entry point into selling digital products. Upload a file or set up a course, and you have a storefront in minutes. It supports digital downloads, courses, memberships, coaching sessions, and physical products. Very low cost and beginner-friendly.

Fees

Free plan	5% transaction fee
Plus (\$29/mo)	2% transaction fee
Pro (\$99/mo)	0% transaction fee
Best for	Beginners selling ebooks, templates, presets, mini courses, or coaching

How to use AI on Payhip

- Use AI to generate a full product line plan: what to sell, at what price, in what order to launch.
- AI can write product descriptions, checkout page copy, and confirmation email templates.
- Use Claude to create the actual digital product: ebook drafts, template copy, course outlines.

Quick comparison — which platform should you choose?

Platform	Monthly cost	Transaction fee	AI potential	Best for
Whop	\$0	2.7%	Very high	Everything — courses, community, software
Kajabi	\$55–\$319	0%	Very high	All-in-one power users
Teachable	\$36–\$374	0–5%	High	Beginner course creators
Thinkific	\$0–\$374	0%	High	Course + community combo

Gumroad	\$0–\$10	3–10%	High	Simple digital downloads, fast launch
Skool	\$99	0%	Moderate	Gamified communities
Mighty Networks	\$99–\$179	2–3%	Moderate	Tribe-building, niche networks
Podia	\$0–\$89	0–8%	High	Budget Kajabi alternative
Payhip	\$0–\$99	0–5%	High	Beginners, simple storefronts

Recommendation: Start with Whop (no monthly cost, all-in-one) or Gumroad (simplest possible start). Upgrade to Kajabi or Thinkific once you are consistently earning and need more marketing automation.

SECTION 2 — YOUTUBE MONETIZATION

YouTube — how to enable monetization

YouTube pays creators through the YouTube Partner Program (YPP). Once accepted, you earn a share of ad revenue on your videos, Shorts, and live streams — plus access to memberships, Super Chats, and shopping. YouTube has paid over \$100 billion to creators since 2021.

The two tiers of YPP

Early Access (Tier 1)	Full Monetization (Tier 2)
• 500+ subscribers • 3 public uploads in last 90 days • 3,000 watch hours in last 12 months OR 3M Shorts views in 90 days Unlocks: Channel memberships, Super Thanks, Super Chats, Super Stickers, Shopping	• 1,000+ subscribers • 4,000 public watch hours in last 12 months OR 10M Shorts views in 90 days Unlocks everything in Tier 1 PLUS: Ad revenue sharing on long-form videos, Shorts ad revenue (45% to creator), YouTube Premium revenue share

Step-by-step: how to apply for YPP

1	Meet the requirements Hit the subscriber and watch hour thresholds above. Your channel must have no active Community Guideline strikes and no history of spam or deceptive content.
2	Enable 2-Step Verification Go to your Google Account settings → Security → 2-Step Verification. This is mandatory — YouTube will reject your YPP application without it.
3	Go to YouTube Studio Visit studio.youtube.com , then click 'Earn' in the left sidebar. If your channel qualifies, you will see the option to apply.
4	Review and accept YPP terms Read and accept the YouTube Partner Program terms. You must agree before proceeding.
5	Connect a Google AdSense account You need an AdSense account linked to receive payments. If you do not have one, YouTube will prompt you to create one. Payments go to this account.
6	Submit for review YouTube manually reviews your channel to confirm it complies with all policies. This takes approximately 30 days. You will receive an email when the decision is made.

7

Enable individual video monetization

Once approved, go to YouTube Studio → Content, and for each video click the \$ icon to turn on monetization and choose which ad formats to allow.

YouTube earning features

Feature	Earning potential	AI automation?
Ad revenue (long-form)	~55% of ad revenue to creator. Avg \$1–8 CPM depending on niche and audience country.	AI helps you pick high-CPM niches and script ad-friendly content
Shorts ad revenue	45% of Shorts creator pool. Lower RPM than long-form but scales with volume.	AI can generate 30+ Shorts scripts from one long video
Channel memberships	\$0.99–\$499/month. You keep ~70% after platform cuts.	AI writes perks, welcome messages, and exclusive content plans
Super Chats & Super Thanks	Real-time donations during live streams and on uploaded videos.	AI scripts engaging live stream hooks that encourage donations
YouTube Shopping	Sell merchandise directly from your channel page.	AI generates product descriptions and thumbnail ad copy
YouTube Premium	Proportional share when Premium subscribers watch your content.	Passive — no specific action needed

AI strategies for YouTube creators

Content creation

- Use Claude to generate a 12-month content calendar in your niche — batch 3–6 months of video ideas at once so you never run out.
- Paste a video topic into AI and ask it to write a full script with hook, sections, and call-to-action — cut scripting time from hours to minutes.
- Use AI to repurpose every long-form video into: 5 Shorts scripts, 3 tweet threads, 1 Instagram caption, and 1 email newsletter.
- AI can research what the top 5 videos in your niche cover, identify gaps, and suggest angles nobody else has done.
- Use Claude to write 5 A/B test thumbnail title options for every video and pick the highest-curiosity version.

Channel growth

- Use AI to write optimised video descriptions with timestamps, keywords, and links — good descriptions increase watch time and SEO.
- AI can generate 20 community post ideas per month to keep your audience engaged between uploads.
- Ask Claude to analyse your top-performing videos and identify what topics, formats, and hooks are working — then double down.
- Use AI to write responses to comments en masse — this boosts your engagement rate which helps the algorithm.

Monetization optimisation

- AI can identify the highest-CPM niches (personal finance, tech reviews, software tutorials, real estate) so you can plan content around better-paying ad categories.
- Use Claude to write your channel membership perks page and tier descriptions to maximise subscriber conversion.
- AI can script live stream segments specifically designed to encourage Super Chats — Q&A hooks, milestone announcements, and community goals.

Important rules — what gets you demonetized

YouTube's updated 'inauthentic content' policy (updated July 2025) specifically targets mass-produced, AI-generated content with no unique human contribution. Channels with repetitive, template-based videos can have monetization removed even if they previously qualified. AI must be used as a tool to enhance your content, not replace your creative voice.

SECTION 3 — TIKTOK MONETIZATION

TikTok — how to enable monetization

TikTok has replaced the original Creator Fund with the Creator Rewards Program, which pays significantly better rates. TikTok also offers LIVE Gifts, TikTok Shop affiliates, TikTok Pulse (ad revenue), and brand partnership tools. Together, creators earned over \$5.5 billion from TikTok in 2025.

TikTok monetization programs overview

Program	Followers needed	Pay rate	Notes
Creator Rewards Program	10,000+	\$0.40–\$1.00/1K views	Videos must be 1min+, original, high quality
LIVE Gifts	1,000+	Variable (diamonds → cash)	Need to stream regularly to earn well
TikTok Shop Affiliate	1,000+	8–20% commission	Link products in videos; huge earning potential
TikTok Pulse	100,000+	Ad revenue share	Top 4% of content by engagement; invite-based
Brand Partnerships	10,000–50,000+	\$300–\$5,000+ per post	Negotiated directly; not in-app
Tips feature	Any size	Direct fan tips	Viewers send money directly; low friction

Step-by-step: how to apply for Creator Rewards Program

1

Meet the requirements

You need 10,000+ followers, 100,000 video views in the last 30 days, account age of 30+ days, and a personal account (not business) in good standing with no guideline violations.

2

Switch to a Creator account

Go to Profile → Settings → Manage Account → Switch to Creator Account. Business accounts cannot access Creator Rewards.

3

Open Creator Tools

In the TikTok app, go to Profile → Menu (≡) → Settings and Privacy → Creator Tools.

4

Select Creator Rewards Program

You will see the program if you are eligible. If not visible, you do not yet meet the thresholds. Tap it to begin the application.

5	Complete the application Submit any required ID verification and tax information. TikTok reviews applications and typically responds within 1–3 weeks.
6	Enable individual features Once in the program, go back to Creator Tools to separately enable LIVE Gifts, Tips, and TikTok Shop affiliate if available in your region.
7	Post 1-minute+ original videos Creator Rewards only pays on videos over 1 minute that meet originality requirements. Reposts and low-effort content are excluded.

TikTok Shop Affiliate — the biggest earning opportunity

TikTok Shop affiliate lets you add product links to your videos and earn 8–20% commission on every sale. A creator with 500K followers selling a \$50 product to 0.1% of viewers per video earns \$500+ per video in commission alone. This often exceeds Creator Rewards income by 5–10x.

1	Qualify 1,000+ followers, personal account, no strikes. Available in US, UK, Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, Vietnam, and several other markets.
2	Open TikTok Shop Seller Center Visit seller-us.tiktok.com (or your regional equivalent). Log in with your TikTok account.
3	Apply as an affiliate Select 'Affiliate' (not Seller). Fill out the application — usually approved within 24–48 hours.
4	Browse the product marketplace Find products relevant to your audience. Filter by commission rate and category. Prioritise products you actually use or believe in.
5	Add product links to videos In the TikTok app when posting, tap 'Add link' → 'Product'. Select the product. It will appear as a shopping bag icon on your video.
6	Track and optimise Use TikTok's affiliate analytics to see which products convert. Double down on winners and remove underperformers.

AI strategies for TikTok creators

Content creation

- Use AI to generate 30 video hooks for any topic — the first 3 seconds of a TikTok is everything. Test multiple hooks and see which drives the highest watch-through rate.

- Paste a trending sound or topic into Claude and ask for 5 video concepts that use it naturally — staying on trend without copying.
- AI can generate a full 7-day posting schedule with video concepts, captions, and hashtag sets for each day.
- Use Claude to write voiceover scripts for faceless TikToks — explainer videos, list videos, and educational content all work well faceless.
- AI can help you research which content format (tutorial, story, reaction, before/after) works best in your niche.

TikTok Shop affiliate automation

- Use AI to research which products on TikTok Shop have the highest commission rate AND the most social proof (reviews, sold count) — prioritise these for your first videos.
- Ask Claude to write a product video script for each affiliate product: problem → product as solution → how to use → CTA to buy.
- Use AI to generate 10 different video angles for the same product — each targets a different pain point or audience segment.
- AI can help you write response comments on your shop videos that nudge viewers toward purchasing without feeling pushy.

Growth and algorithm

- Use Claude to research TikTok SEO: identify the search terms your target audience uses and include them naturally in captions and spoken audio.
- AI can identify the best posting times for your niche based on when your audience is most active — cross-reference with TikTok Analytics.
- Ask AI to analyse your last 20 videos and identify which format, length, and topic is driving the most views and shares.

Important: TikTok's authenticity policy

TikTok specifically penalises content that looks mass-produced or automated. The Creator Rewards Program requires 'original content' — AI-written scripts are fine as long as you record them genuinely. Fully faceless, template-driven channels built on AI voiceovers alone have been excluded from monetization since 2024.

SECTION 4 — INSTAGRAM MONETIZATION

Instagram — how to enable monetization

Instagram has removed its direct Reels Play Bonus program (ended March 2023) but introduced more sustainable monetization through Subscriptions, Live Badges, Gifts on Reels, the Creator Marketplace, and Shopping. Over 60% of Reels views now come from non-followers, making it a powerful discovery platform even without paying for ads.

Instagram monetization programs

Feature	Earning potential	AI automation?
Subscriptions	\$0.99–\$99.99/month from loyal fans. You keep ~80% after fees.	AI generates exclusive content ideas, welcome messages, and subscriber perks
Live Badges	Fans buy \$0.99–\$4.99 badges during your Lives. You keep 100%.	AI scripts engaging live Q&A formats that encourage badge purchases
Gifts on Reels	Fans send Stars (\$0.01 each). Minimum \$25 payout threshold.	AI writes scroll-stopping Reels hooks that drive gift-sending impulse
Creator Marketplace	Brand deals negotiated directly. \$500–\$50,000+ per post.	AI writes your media kit, pitch emails, and brand partnership proposals
Instagram Shopping	Sell products directly from posts and Reels.	AI writes product descriptions and Reels-to-purchase scripts
Bonus Programs	Invite-only. Variable pay for meeting view milestones.	AI helps you hit view thresholds by optimising posting frequency and format

Requirements summary

Minimum age	18 years old (mandatory for all monetization features)
Account type	Professional account (Creator or Business) — personal accounts are not eligible
Followers for Gifts on Reels	500+ followers — lowest barrier entry point
Followers for Subscriptions	10,000+ followers
Followers for Live Badges	10,000+ followers + must go live regularly

Country eligibility	US, UK, Canada, Australia, and 40+ other countries. Check Instagram's official eligibility list.
Content policy	Must comply with Community Guidelines, Partner Monetization Policies, and Content Monetization Policies
No fake engagement	Buying followers or likes can result in permanent loss of monetization eligibility

Step-by-step: how to set up each monetization feature

Step 1 — Switch to a Professional account

1	Open Instagram Settings Go to your profile → Menu (≡) → Settings and privacy.
2	Tap 'Account type and tools' Select 'Switch to professional account'. Choose Creator (for influencers and content creators) or Business (for brands and businesses).
3	Set your category Choose the category that best describes your content (e.g. Content Creator, Digital Creator, Entertainer).
4	Connect your Facebook page (optional but recommended) Connecting a Facebook page gives you access to additional tools and the Creator Marketplace.

Step 2 — Enable Gifts on Reels (lowest barrier — do this first)

1	Go to Professional Dashboard Tap your profile → Professional Dashboard.
2	Find 'Your tools' Scroll to the 'Your tools' section.
3	Tap 'Gifts' If you have 500+ followers and are in an eligible country, you will see the Gifts option.
4	Toggle on 'Allow gifts on reels' Once toggled on, viewers can send you Stars on any of your Reels.
5	Check payout threshold Gifts pay out once you reach \$25 worth of Stars. Link a PayPal or bank account through the payment settings.

Step 3 — Enable Live Badges (requires 10K followers)

1	Check eligibility Go to Professional Dashboard → Monetization. If Live Badges are available, you will see it listed.
2	Set up payment Link your payment method in Payout Settings.
3	Go live Start an Instagram Live. Badges become available to your viewers automatically once you are approved.
4	Encourage badges verbally Thank badge buyers by name in the live — this drives more purchases from others watching.

Step 4 — Set up Instagram Subscriptions (requires 10K followers)

1	Check the Professional Dashboard Go to Professional Dashboard → look for 'Set up subscriptions'. If it is not visible, you are not yet eligible.
2	Set your price You can charge \$0.99–\$99.99/month. Most creators start at \$2.99–\$9.99.
3	Create a subscriber benefit Offer exclusive Reels, Stories, Lives, or a close friends list for subscribers. The value of the perk determines conversion.
4	Promote it Post a Reel explaining what subscribers get. Add a 'Subscribe' button prompt in your captions and Stories.

Step 5 — Join the Creator Marketplace for brand deals

1	Go to Creator Marketplace in Professional Dashboard You must have a Creator account connected to a Facebook page.
2	Fill in your profile Add your niche categories, audience demographics, and a rate card for brand partnerships.
3	Browse brand campaigns Brands post open campaigns you can apply to. You can also be discovered directly.
4	Disclose sponsored content Use Instagram's paid partnership label — failing to disclose sponsorships violates FTC rules.

AI strategies for Instagram creators

Reels content creation

- Use AI to generate 30 Reels concepts for your niche in one session. Batch the ideas, then film multiple in one day.
- AI can write your Reels hooks — the first 3 seconds that determine whether someone keeps watching or scrolls away. Test 3–5 different hook formulas.
- Use Claude to write captions for every Reel, including a CTA (call-to-action): directing viewers to subscribe, visit your link in bio, or send a DM.
- AI can generate subtitle text for your Reels — captions increase watch time by 12% on average because many people watch with sound off.
- Use AI to identify the optimal Reels length for your niche: ask Claude to research which durations perform best for [your content type] on Instagram in 2026.

Subscription and membership growth

- Use AI to write your subscription pitch Reel script: 'Here is what subscribers get that regular followers do not — here is why it is worth it.'
- AI can generate a monthly exclusive content calendar for subscribers: 4 exclusive Reels, 2 subscriber-only Stories, 1 Live Q&A prompt.
- Use Claude to write subscriber onboarding DMs: the message someone receives the moment they subscribe, making them feel valued.
- AI can write your subscription tier description and FAQs for your profile page.

Brand partnership strategy

- Use AI to build your media kit: bio, audience demographics, engagement rate, content examples, and rate card — formatted professionally.
- AI can write cold pitch emails to brands in your niche. Give Claude your niche, your follower count, and 3 engagement stats and ask for a compelling outreach email.
- Use Claude to research brands that align with your audience and identify their Instagram ad spend (brands advertising heavily on Instagram are actively looking for creator partnerships).
- AI can draft your brand deal negotiation responses: how to counter a lowball offer, request higher rates, or negotiate product plus cash.

The Instagram + course platform stack

Instagram is your free traffic engine. Whop, Gumroad, or Kajabi is your conversion engine. The strategy: post daily Reels to grow Instagram → collect email subscribers from your bio link → sell courses and memberships through your owned platform. This is the stack that converts social media reach into predictable monthly revenue.

- Use AI to write your bio link landing page copy: one sentence explaining who you are and a single CTA to join your course, email list, or community.
- AI can create a 5-part welcome email sequence for everyone who signs up from your Instagram traffic — building trust before making a sale.
- Use Claude to write Instagram Stories scripts that tease your paid content and funnel viewers to your course or Whop link.

SECTION 5 — THE AI CREATOR STACK

The full AI creator workflow

This is how you combine every tool in this guide into one production system. One hour of AI-assisted work can produce a week of content across YouTube, TikTok, and Instagram — plus fill your course platform with students.

Weekly production workflow with AI

1	Monday — ideation (20 min) Paste your niche into Claude. Ask for 10 YouTube video ideas, 20 TikTok/Reels concepts, and 3 email newsletter topics for the week.
2	Monday — scripting (40 min) Pick your best idea. Use AI to write: 1 full YouTube script (with hook, body, CTA), 5 Shorts scripts from the same topic, 5 TikTok scripts, and 5 Reels scripts.
3	Tuesday/Wednesday — filming (2–3 hrs) Film everything. With scripts ready, a 2-hour session covers YouTube + all short-form for the week.
4	Wednesday/Thursday — editing Edit video. Use AI-generated captions and subtitles. AI tools like Descript or Captions.ai auto-transcribe and edit by text.
5	Friday — publishing and optimization Post YouTube video with AI-written description, tags, and timestamps. Schedule TikToks and Reels. Send email newsletter via Kajabi/Podia/ConvertKit.
6	Friday — course updates (30 min) Use AI to write one new lesson post, one community engagement question, or one exclusive piece of content for your Whop/Kajabi subscribers.
7	Weekend — analytics review (30 min) Paste your analytics into Claude and ask: "What worked this week? What should I do more of next week? What should I stop doing?"

Earnings stack summary

Platform	Monetization type	Realistic monthly	AI leverage
YouTube	Ad revenue, memberships, Super Chats	\$200–\$5,000/mo (10K–100K subs)	Very high — scripts, SEO, repurposing

TikTok Creator Rewards	View-based pay	\$90–\$500/mo at 3M views	High — hooks, volume, Shop affiliate
TikTok Shop Affiliate	Commission per sale	\$500–\$5,000/mo (consistent posting)	Very high — product research, scripts
Instagram Subscriptions	Monthly fan fee	\$200–\$2,000/mo (10K+ engaged)	High — exclusive content planning
Instagram Live Badges	Donation during Lives	\$50–\$500/mo	Moderate — live stream scripts
Whop / Kajabi course	Direct course sales	\$1,000–\$10,000+/mo (with audience)	Very high — course writing, sales copy
Brand partnerships (any)	Sponsored content	\$500–\$20,000+/post (50K+ followers)	High — media kit, pitch writing

Note: All earnings depend heavily on niche, audience quality, consistency, and content format. These are realistic ranges for an active creator posting 3–5x per week. AI speeds up production but does not replace the need for genuine human creativity and audience trust.